

Rocio Perales Valdes

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Education

Georgia Institute of Technology | BS/MS Computer Science | GPA: 3.92/4.0

May 2028

Minor: Law, Science & Technology

Relevant Coursework: Applied Combinatorics; Computational & Model Algorithms; DSA; Linear Algebra; Discrete Math

Skills

Programming: Python, Java, C++ , JavaScript, HTML/CSS

AI/ML: PyTorch, JAX, TensorFlow, Sparse Autoencoders (SAEs), Slurm, VLAs, ROS2, PID Control

Languages: English, Spanish, French (conversational)

Professional & Research Experience

Undergraduate Researcher | [PAIR Lab](#) – Georgia Tech

Nov. 2025 – Present

- Leading interpretability SAE-based work on VLAs ($\pi_{0.5}$) targeting singular feature ablation to test feature transferability from base to finetuned models. Advised by [Stepan Shabalín](#) and Prof. Animesh Garg.
- Assisted in ICRA paper on Progress Reward Model training achieving a 10-15% performance jump on precise tasks.

Summer Research Fellow | [Institute for AI Policy and Strategy \(IAPS\)](#)

Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026

- Synthesized a 269-page Great American AI Act discussion draft into a 2-page decision brief for the **Policy Team**
- Authored a public [explainer](#) and policy recommendations on the FCC's proposed ban on foreign-made advanced robotics, securing review from 5 policy experts through direct outreach
- Conducted internal robotics threat modeling for the **Frontier Security** team, including BOTEK calculations on drone attacks and interviews with 6 stakeholders across industry, military, academia, and think tanks

ML Solutions Intern | ZeruDrones

Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Trained **YOLO models** on AWS GPU instances and integrated **autoencoders** for powerline anomaly detection

Solo Developer | [Personalized Word Count for Google Docs](#)

Jun. 2024 – July 2024

- Google Docs extension allowing for tailored word counts with **3K+ downloads**

Leadership & Campus Involvement

Chair | AI & Student Body Subcommittee – Georgia Tech

Jan. 2026 – Present

- Selected by Provost Raheem Beyah to chair subcommittee for Georgia Tech's institutional AI strategy
- Designed and deployed a campus-wide AI usage survey collecting **1K+ responses** without monetary incentives

Co-Director | AI Safety Initiative ([AISL.dev](#))

Jan. 2026 – Present

- Lead a 15-person exec organization with \$30K+ of external funding and set overall strategy
- Created a Policy Fellowship curriculum run as a course seminar with Georgia Tech's OMSCS program
- Led **deepfake governance research** under **Dr. Margaret Kosal**

Software Developer | [RoboJackets](#) – [RoboCup SSL](#)

Aug. 2024 – Sept. 2025

- Led implementation on the [multi-robot pathfinding system](#) (C++/ROS2, real-time decision-making under uncertainty); placed **2nd in the technical challenge** and **4th overall** at [RoboCup 2025 Intl](#)

Awards & Recognition

[Stamps Walk-On President's Scholarship](#) | Georgia Institute of Technology

March 2026

- Competitively selected for full-ride scholarship recognizing academic achievement and leadership

[AI@ATL Hackathon Winner](#) | [Major League Hacking](#)

Oct. 2024

- Built a **synthetic medical dataset** and **prompt injection testing framework**; **1st place**, AI Safety track

Miscellaneous Recognition:

- [AI Safety, Ethics, and Society Course](#), Center for AI Safety (Nov. 2025 – Feb. 2026)
- Spanish Translation Assistance, [METR & Redwood Research OpenAI/HF Incident Investigation](#) (Aug. 2026)

Conferences: Economic Futures Symposium (DC, Sept. 2025)*, ControlConf (Berkeley, Apr. 2026), OASIS (Berkeley, Jan. 2026)*, DCMC (DC, Apr. 2026)*, Verified: The Conference (DC, Sept. 2026)*[†], GCP (Bay Area, Aug. 2026)*

*Invited attendee, closed-door [†]Helped organize

Personal interests: Blogging on AI futures (Substack: [rociopv](#)), music composition and production, running, soccer